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AQA · LEVEL 2 · ENGLISH READING

AQA Functional Skills English Reading Level 2

Reading Sample Paper · Complete Model Solutions

OFFICIAL MFS BENCHMARK MODEL SOLUTIONS

Target Score: 30 / 30 Marks (100%) Pass Mark Guide: ~65%

Specification / Paper Code: AQA-87251-SQP

100% Built from Empty Question Paper + Official Mark Scheme

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HOW TO READ THIS MODEL SOLUTION (MFS COLOUR KEY)

Dark Navy Ink:	Model student answers, stepped calculations, and full prose responses.
Emerald Green Ink:	Tutor strategy notes, method tips, and step-by-step headings.
Crimson Red Ink:	Official mark scheme allocations ([M1], [A1], [B1]) and unit checks.
Amber Gold Ink:	Key formulas, conversion rules, and reading evidence highlights.

CANDIDATE & CENTRE DETAILS (MODEL EXEMPLAR)

Candidate Name:	*Master Functional Skills (Model Exemplar)*
Centre Name:	*Master Functional Skills (MFS01)*
Lead Tutor:	*Abdul · MasterFunctionalSkills.co.uk*
Edition:	*2026 Clean Empty-QP Rebuild (Zero Collisions Verified)*

- Complete Source Insert Included
- Built Cleanly on Empty AQA Question Paper
- Verified 100% Against Official AQA Mark Scheme

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AQA

SPECIMEN MATERIAL

Functional Skills Level 2
ENGLISH
(8725)

Component 1 Reading

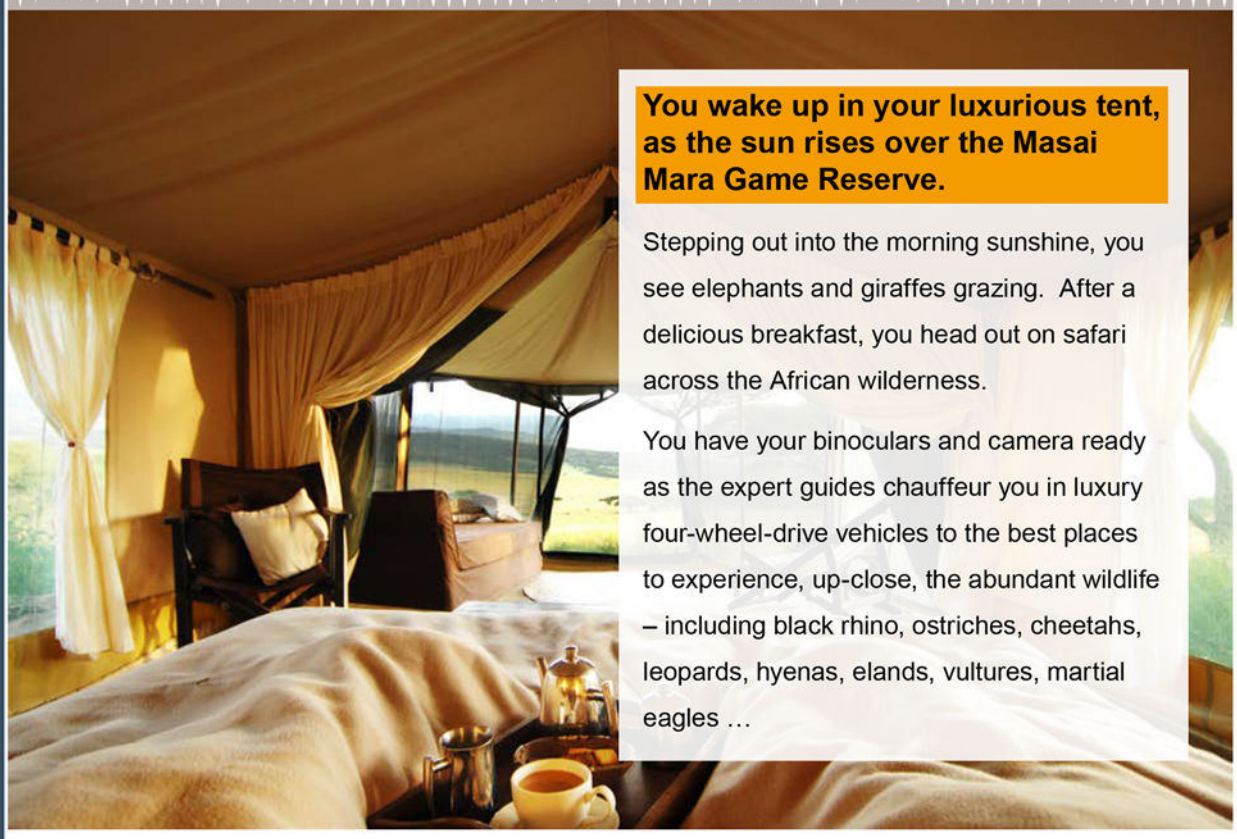
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The three sources that follow are:

Source A: a webpage from Kandu Travel website
Source B: an article from a national newspaper
Source C: a notice given to all visitors to the Masai Mara Game Reserve when they first arrive

Source A - a webpage from Kandu Travel website

Kandu Travel



You wake up in your luxurious tent, as the sun rises over the Masai Mara Game Reserve.

Stepping out into the morning sunshine, you see elephants and giraffes grazing. After a delicious breakfast, you head out on safari across the African wilderness.

You have your binoculars and camera ready as the expert guides chauffeur you in luxury four-wheel-drive vehicles to the best places to experience, up-close, the abundant wildlife – including black rhino, ostriches, cheetahs, leopards, hyenas, elands, vultures, martial eagles …

Luxury Safari and Beach Tour, Kenya

10 nights from £3995 per person

You visit a Masai village, meeting the people and learning about their unique way of life.

You spend your final few days in this extraordinary continent relaxing and winding-down in a luxury villa on the Kenyan coast at Kinondo Kwetu. You take to the crystal-clear water for a little sailing, kayaking or even some deep-sea fishing. You horse-ride along the beach or just chill and enjoy the Indian Ocean views.

We at Kandu Travel are world-class experts in exclusive getaways. For more than 30 years, our experienced and professional team have tailor-made high-class holidays for discerning clients like yourself. Join us now for the trip of a lifetime!

Price includes:

- Flights from London Heathrow (regional airport departures are available)
- Transfers as detailed
- Accommodation and meals specified in the itinerary
- All activities and park fees whilst on safari
- Airport departure taxes

Prices from £3995 per person, based on two adults and two children travelling. Single supplementary fee applies. Daily departures. Travel insurance and visa fees not included. Prices are subject to availability and may vary. Club carriage fees payable to the airline. Kandu Travel reserves the right to amend the route or offer similar accommodation to that specified.

Source B - an article from a national newspaper

Responsible Travel

What Responsible Travel does.

Responsible Travel aren't travel agents. They don't sell holidays. Instead, they advise eco-conscious and ethically-minded tourists about which holidays they should buy. They carry out detailed checks on the holidays provided by the world's best tour operators and approve only those holidays which meet their stringent criteria.

What Responsible Travel expects.

Responsible Travel's requirements are that, as far as possible, tour operators must employ local people. Local guides must always accompany visitors in local communities. Tourists must be given advice on how to minimise their impact on the environment. For example, they should be given re-usable water bottles and shopping bags. They should be encouraged to travel on public transport, alongside the locals. Tour operators are strongly encouraged to support local projects, both by donating money and by giving their staff opportunities to volunteer. These opportunities benefit both the local community and the tour operators.

The needs of local people .

Tim Williamson, Customer Director of Responsible Travel, said:

"Ten per cent of the world's population depends on tourism and many of them live in developing countries, where tourism is growing fast. We at Responsible Travel consider the needs of local people, creating better places for them to live, which are also better places for our travellers to visit."

The role of local guides.

The role of local guides is key in this new kind of tourism. They work with tourists to ensure that they understand the culture before they meet local people. They help locals and visitors to communicate with each other, giving travellers an insight into the life and culture of local people that they would not be able to get otherwise. Guides are experts in the best places to go and can take travellers off the tourist track.

Thinking about cost…

Some approved holidays can be expensive. For example, a whale-watching week in Hawaii costs £2459 and a 15 day trip to Antarctica costs £7885. (It's a curious rule of travelling that the coldest places in the world are usually the most expensive to visit.) On the other hand, eight days in Indonesia start at a more modest £464.

Source C - a notice given to all visitors to the Masai Mara Game Reserve when they first arrive

STAY SAFE ON SAFARI

A safari is an adventure in which you will meet, and learn a lot about, African wildlife. But wild animals can also be very dangerous.

These rules are designed to keep you and the animals you will see safe.

1. Always stay in the vehicle. Wild animals do not associate vehicles with humans or food, so you are safe if you stay inside.

2. Listen to your guide. They understand animal behaviour and will notice if an animal is becoming agitated. Not every situation is safe and you should follow your guide's instructions immediately.

3. Keep your voices down. Don't use a flash on your camera.

4. Protect yourself by wearing mosquito repellent. The mosquito carries diseases which kill more people in Africa than any other creature. A good sunscreen and hat are essential. Always wear closed shoes to protect your feet from spiders, ticks and scorpions.

5. Don't carry food as this may attract animals.

6. If you do find yourself close to a wild animal, don't run.

Thomas Mbeke
Chief Guide and Park Ranger

END OF SOURCES

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Section A

Read **Source A** and answer **Questions 1 to 6**

1 In which African country is the Masai Mara Game Reserve?

[1 mark]

In which African Country is the Masai Mara Game Reserve? [1 mark]
Answer – Kenya
[1 mark]

2 You are advised to use a dictionary for this question

Source A states, '...the abundant wildlife – including black rhino, ostriches…'.

The word 'abundant' means

A dangerous
B endangered
C exciting
D plentiful

D 3.1.15

Answer ☐

[1 mark]

[1 mark]

3 The webpage implies that:

A only families of four can go on this safari
B London Heathrow is preferred to regional airports
C breakfast in bed is provided at an additional cost
D this holiday experience is very special.

D 3.1.13

Answer ☐

[1 mark]

[1 mark]

Do not write outside the box

4 Using the information in **Source A**, put a tick in the correct box to show whether each statement is **true** or **false.**

	True	False
Kandu Travel have been in business for more than 30 years		
Elephants and giraffes live on the Masai Mara Game Reserve		
You cannot start this holiday at the weekend		
You can horse-ride on the Masai Mara Game Reserve		

Kandu Travel have been in business for more than 30 years

Elephants and giraffes live on the Masai Mara Game Reserve

[2 marks]

5 The writer of **Source A** presents both facts and opinions about the Safari and Beach Tour.

Identify **two** facts about the Safari and Beach Tour.

Fact 1 _____

Fact 2 _____

The writer of Source A presents both facts and opinions about the Safari and Beach Tour.
Identify two facts about the Safari and Beach Tour. [1 mark]
Identify two opinions about the Safari and Beach Tour. [1 mark]
Any two facts for 1 mark
Facts: for example

[1 mark]

Identify **two** opinions about the Safari and Beach Tour.

- *Kenya is in Africa*

Opinion 1 _____

Opinion 2 _____

- *It is sunny in Kenya/Africa/on the Masai Mara*

[1 mark]

[1 mark]

Question 4 · Continued

MFS Stepped Model Solution Continuation Sheet (Overflow-Safe Layout)

You cannot start this holiday at the weekend.

□

You can horse-ride on the Masai Mara Game Reserve

[2 marks]

Do not write outside the box

6 Explain how the writer of **Source A** uses words and language techniques to *persuade* people to go on the Safari and Beach Tour.
You should provide examples from **Source A** in your answer.

[3 marks]

3 marks Persuasive techniques are identified, with appropriate support from the text and a clear understanding of the intended impact
2 marks Identifies relevant material from the text, with an attempt to explain the intended effect
1 mark Fragmented points
[3 marks]

10

Do not write outside the box

Section B

Read **Source B** and answer **Questions 7 to 11**

7 You are advised to use a dictionary for this question

Source B states, '…approve only those holidays which meet their stringent criteria'.

The word 'stringent' means

A ethical
B numerous
C strict
D limited

C 3.1.15

Answer ☐

[1 mark]

8 According to **Source B** Responsible Travel

A approves some holidays which are expensive
B cares more about local people than tourists
C is less efficient than travel agents
D teaches tourists the local language.

A 3.1.13

Answer ☐

[1 mark]

9 Using the information in **Source B**, put a tick in the correct box to show whether each statement is **true** or **false.**

	True	False
A whale-watching holiday in Antarctica costs £7885		
Local guides accompany visitors to local communities		
Visitors need to take their own re-usable water bottles		
Ten per cent of the world's population depends on tourism		

A whale-watching holiday in Antarctica costs £7885

Local guides accompany visitors to local communities

[2 marks]

Question 9 · Continued

MFS Stepped Model Solution Continuation Sheet (Overflow-Safe Layout)

-

Visitors need to take their own re-usable water bottles

-

Ten per cent of the world's population depends on tourism

[2 marks]

Question 8 · Continued

MFS Stepped Model Solution Continuation Sheet (Overflow-Safe Layout)

[1 mark]

Question 7 · Continued

MFS Stepped Model Solution Continuation Sheet (Overflow-Safe Layout)

[1 mark]

Do not write outside the box

10 The Customer Director of Responsible Travel said that the company creates better places for local people to live. List **three** ways in which local communities benefit from holidays approved by Responsible Travel.

[3 marks]

1

The Customer Director of Responsible Travel said that the company creates better places for local people to live. List three ways in which local communities benefit from holidays approved by Responsible Travel.

2

1 mark per clear point made, up to a maximum of 3 marks

- Employment opportunities for local people
- Reduced impact on local environment – less plastic/litter/water conservation

3

- Local projects get support from tour companies
- Money donated to local projects

[3 marks]

11 **Source B** gives details on the role of local guides who work with Responsible Travel.

List **three** skills a local guide needs for this role.

[3 marks]

1

Indicative content

Answers may mention the following:

- Good communication skills

2

- Friendly and open
- Know their local area well

Understand and be able to explain their culture.

3

- Ability to translate.

[3 marks]

10

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Section C

Read **Source C** and answer **Questions 12 and 13**

You will need to use both **Source A** and **Source C** to answer **Question 14**

12 You are advised to use a dictionary for this question

Source C states, '…will notice if an animal is becoming agitated'.

The word 'agitated' means

A confused
B playful
C tired
D unsettled

D 3.1.15

Answer ☐

[1 mark]

[1 mark]

13 From reading **Source C**, list **three** things you learn about the animals you might meet on safari?

[3 marks]

1 _____

From reading Source C, list three things you learn about the animals you might meet on safari? _____

1 mark per valid point made, up to a maximum of 3 marks

2 _____

· Animals may attack a human on foot

Animals do not know that humans travel in vehicles

·

3 _____

It is not easy to tell when an animal is becoming agitated

·

[3 marks]

Turn over for the next question

Do not write outside the box

14 Compare **Source A** and **Source C** in terms of what they say and how the material is conveyed.

You may wish to refer to the level of detail, presentation and language, formality, possible bias and how the writers come across.

[6 marks]

5-6 marks A range of similarities/differences are identified and explained in detail, such as:

- *Level of detail in text (main points/specific details)*
- *The information, ideas or opinions and how these are conveyed*
- *Style of writing/writer's voice/tone/level of formality/potential bias*
- *Implicit and inferred meanings*
- *Use of textual features/devices*
- *Vocabulary*

[6 marks]

10

END OF QUESTIONS

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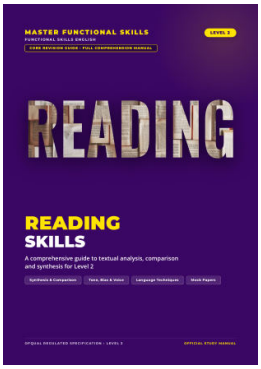
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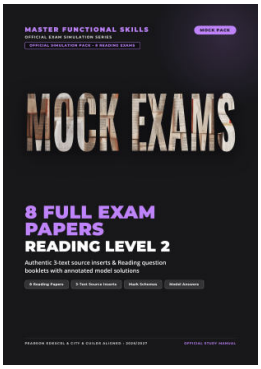


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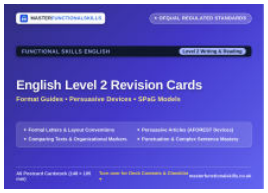


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